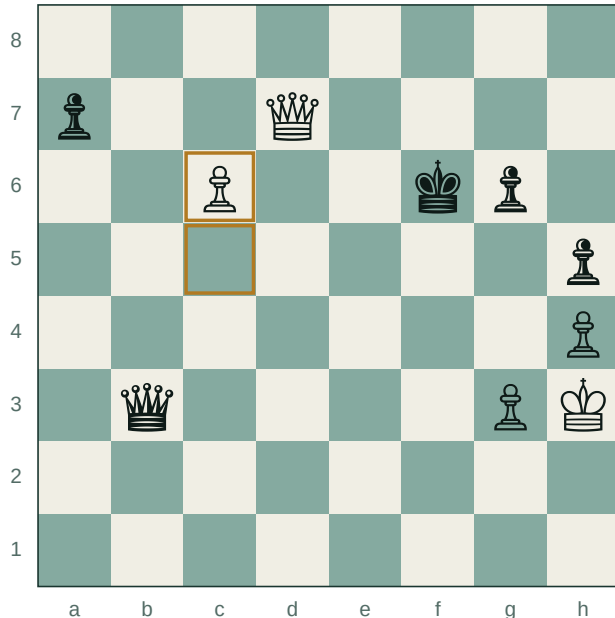


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 60

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 60.c6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

60...Qe6+ 61. Qxe6+ Kxe6 62. c7 Kd7 63. c8=Q+ Kxc8

60...Qe6+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on h3 and queen on d7. Recorded reply: **61.Qxe6+**.

61...Kxe6 The king captures the queen on e6. Recorded reply: **62.c7**.

62...Kd7 The king moves from e6 to d7. Recorded reply: **63.c8=Q+**.

63...Kxc8 The king captures the queen on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on h3. Absolute pin: pawn on g3.